

by anyone. Maintenance won't be an issue as you can print your own replacement parts and customisations. The software for LulzBot is compatible with Linux, Mac OS and Windows.

9. PrintrBot Simple

The 'Printrbot Simple' is a simple, cheap RepRap-based 3D printer, which is easy to build and use. The kit costs between \$299-\$349 while the assembled version costs \$449.



One of the cheapest open source 3D printers out there, the Printrbot Simple also weighs less at 4 kgs. However, the build volume of the Printrbot Simple is lower compared to other 3D printers and stands at 101.6 mm x 101.6 mm x 101.6 mm. The Simple doesn't come with its own software but works very well with open source solutions such as OpenSCAD (for designing), Slic3r (to generate G-Code from STL files), Repetier (to load STL files, interface with Slic3r and drive the printing process) and ParaView (for visualising and retouching a model). If you intend to buy the filament cartridge from the manufacturer, it will cost you around \$30 - still cheaper than other printers like Ultimaker. Also, the printer head on the Simple is limited to one while other printers can have 2-3 printer heads. It has an average printing speed ranging from 60-65 mm/sec but with a good resolution of 0.1 mm of layer height, which is amongst the best.

10. Litto

The sleek-looking 'Litto' printer has an unobtrusive framework and gives easy access to the build platform. This compact printer features easy-to-use software and delivers quick printing. It can print objects with a build volume of 134.6 mm x 119.3 mm x 175.2 mm. Litto has a layer resolution of 0.1 mm-0.3 mm and it can print with PLA (also ABS, but it isn't officially supported). Litto uses the Coordia software, which is compatible with Windows and Mac OS. The software makes it easy for beginners to create or modify files for printing. The Litto can be connected to a computer or can also print files from an SD card. With a cost of \$999 for a DIY kit (or +\$300 for an assembled version), the Litto comes across as an expensive printer.